

Southdown
 Lyons Cement Plant

May 21, 1998

Mr. Robert Jorgenson
 Supervisor, Field Services Section
 Air Pollution Control Division
 Colorado Department of Public Health and Environment
 4300 Cherry Creek Drive South
 Denver, CO 80264 - 1530

Mr. Jeff Zayach
 Boulder County Health
 Environmental Health
 3450 Broadway
 Boulder, CO 80304

Re: Closure: Old Baghouse Dust Pit/New Dust Pit Design/Fugitive Dust Control Plan
 Southdown Inc., Lyons Cement Plant
 Lyons, Colorado

Dear Mr. Jorgenson and Mr. Zayach:

It is Southdown's policy to work with concerned community groups, the county and the state to comply with all regulations and resolve pending concerns promptly. The following is a time line for the Old Dust Pit reclamation, new pit design concepts and an enhanced fugitive dust control plan.

OLD DUST PIT ACTION AND TIMING

As stated in our letter of March 9, 1998 reclamation has begun on "B/D pit" (dust storage pit). As of this letter, half of the pit has been covered. We are expediting the reclamation process. The remainder of the pit will be covered by the end of June, 1998.

NEW DUST PIT DESIGN

The new dust storage pit will be "C-pit". "C-pit" is closer to the plant and will reduce travel distance by 75%. The actual pit has an area of about 20 acres and is currently 20 to 100 feet below the existing ground level. There is a partially vegetated wind break along the west rim of the pit. Of the 20 acres, only about seven acres at one time will be used for dust storage. The remaining 13 acres will be covered with shale. A sprinkling system is being installed to wet the dust disposal area in the pit on a regular basis. The cost of this project is about \$60,000 and is projected to be installed by the end of June, 1998.

FUGITIVE CONTROLS/MONITORING/RECORD KEEPING

The dust from the baghouse is controlled by a pelletizing process (pugging) where by the dust is exposed to a water spray as the dust exits the silo and passes along a paddle screw conveyor forming pebble size pellets. These pellets have a moisture content of 20 to 25%. These pellets then drop into our haul truck for direct transport to the dust pit. (We have increased the size of our haul trucks from 50 ton capacity to 95 ton capacity which reduces the number of trips taken.) To reduce exposure the truck is only loaded to 50 to 75% of capacity. This process was witnessed during our 1996 Boulder County inspection.

The frequency of dust disposal varies greatly with process changes and dust sales demand. There may be no loads to several loads of dust hauled a day. On the average, 45 loads may be hauled in a week. The haul trucks are used during the day for regular quarry operations. To maximize the use of our equipment, we generally haul dust during the evening and throughout the weekend.

It is our policy to apply environmentally safe Magnesium Chloride to our heavily traveled haul roads including the road to the dust pit. We have applied this preparation for the past three years and will again this year. This year's annual application will start on May, 22 1998. Additionally, there is daily

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watering of untreated roads and travel areas throughout the plant to control dust. Paved roads are routinely swept with two mobile sweepers.

We have sent several members of our staff through the Visible Emissions Training program sponsored by the CDPHE. This is to insure that there will usually be someone on site that has VE training. These employees are Harry Baca, certified 3/98. Steve Mossberg - certified 10/97, Greg Wright - certified 10/97 and Richard Adams - certified 4/96. Mr. Mossberg, Mr. Mike Price and Mr. Wright were unable to be certified during the spring 1998 classes due the March blizzard and scheduling conflicts but are registered for the Fall 1998 session.

We have a dust monitoring program that was submitted with our Title V application in December of 1995. This program was initiated in January of 1996. The day shift, Production shift supervisor, makes daily rounds of the plant inspecting for dusty conditions. When an area is identified that needs attention every effort is made to correct the situation. If the scope of the problem is greater than his ability to solve the problem he issues a work request through our computerized maintenance system to rectify the situation. This information is kept in a daily log which is kept by the plant compliance manager. We also have a routine maintenance schedule which enable us to provide regular maintenance on all our dust collection equipment. There plant personnel on site 24 hours a day to ensure proper plant operation. Record are maintained for plant watering, indicating the frequency the number gallon of water applied. If there are any question please call me at (303) 823-2113.

Lastly, daily photos are taken of the facility with date back camera to document on an on-going basis our compliance regarding fugitive emissions.

In Summary... We strive to comply with the letter and spirit of all regulations and are trying to be both sensitive and responsive to neighbor concerns. John Lohr and I will be in contact with Mr. Cargill, keeping him and his group apprised of our progress in alleviating their concerns.

Sincerely,



Steve Mossberg
Compliance Manager

cc:

Environmental Affairs, Southdown Inc., Houston T X

Richard Cargill, St. Vrain Valley Watchdogs